HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Things will never get better."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Things will never get better." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What, exactly, do I believe can never change?
- ☐ Has a hard season ever shifted later, even a little?
- ☐ Am I reading the whole future from how I feel today?
- ☐ What help or mercy am I leaving out of the picture?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend who said their situation could never improve?
- ☐ What is one day I can live without settling the whole future?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ A hard season is not the whole story. God can bring change I cannot see yet, and I can take the next day as it comes.
- ☐ God can bring change I cannot see yet.
- ☐ Weeping may last the night, and joy can still come.
- ☐ I do not have to solve the whole future today.
- ☐ Mercy has met me before.
- ☐ I can ask for help while I wait.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 30:5
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."
- ☐ Lamentations 3:22–23
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ When the "it will never change" feeling came: Each day, write down one moment when the future felt closed. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 30:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "This night is hard, and joy can still come in the morning.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio or the Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Name the forecast. Write the sentence "Things will never get better," then write what you actually know and what you do not know yet.
- ☐ Remember one shift. Write two hard seasons that later eased, even partly. Read them when the forecast feels final.
- ☐ Ask for one practical help. Tell one safe person what feels stuck, and ask for one specific kind of help this week.
- ☐ Get help if the darkness includes wanting to die. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988, or tell someone near you today.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Things will never get better.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment that was not the whole future
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Things will never get better~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, this season feels endless. Remind me that a hard night is not the end of Your mercy. Help me live this day, and to ask for the help I need. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.